1. Purpose

To establish a structured, rapid-response framework designed to prioritize public health by immediately containing food safety risks while ensuring full compliance with the mandatory reporting and traceability requirements of the DOH and FDA. By identifying root causes to prevent recurrence and utilizing professional, empathetic communication, the SOP facilitates operational recovery while simultaneously safeguarding the restaurant's brand integrity and reputation.

2. Scope

It encompasses a comprehensive range of critical food safety emergencies, serving as the primary directive for any event that threatens consumer health or operational continuity. It specifically addresses suspected foodborne illness outbreaks and incidents of physical contamination, such as the presence of glass or metal fragments, as well as chemical hazards like mislabeled cleaning agents or toxic residues. Furthermore, the protocol extends to administrative crises, providing clear procedural guidance for handling unannounced inspections, regulatory non-compliance notices, or immediate shutdown orders issued by the Local Health Office. By accounting for both internal contamination events and external regulatory interventions, this SOP ensures that the company and brand maintains a state of constant readiness to mitigate risks and uphold the stringent safety mandate.

3. Responsibilities

3.1. All Service, Warehousing, and Customer Representatives Employees

Shall identify a potential crisis and receive complaints with empathy. He/she shall immediately escalate the encountered potential crisis to the immediate supervisors without admitting liability.

3.2. All Shift and Restaurant Managers and Area Manager

Shall act as the first responder to the potential crisis. He/she shall initiate the incident report, halt the sale of suspected items, and secure the physical evidence.

3.3. Quality Assurance or Food Safety Compliance Officer

As mandated by RA 10611, shall be responsible for conducting the internal traceability audit (farm-to-fork). She/he shall be responsible for reviewing all HACCP logs and coordinate with the Local Government Unit (LGU) or Sanitary Inspector for testing.

3.4. Supply Chain Manager/ Supervisor

Shall be responsible for the "one step back" traceability by contacting the suppliers to verify the records on hand.

3.5. President/ Crisis Management Director

Shall hold the final authority on facilities closure or product recalls.

4. Definition of Terms

- **HACCP (Hazard Analysis and Critical Control Point):** A systematic preventative framework used to identify, monitor, and mitigate biological, chemical, and physical hazards across all operational workflows.
- **RA 10611 (Food Safety Act of 2013):** The foundational Philippine statutory law governing food safety mandates, enforcing legal compliance, institutional traceability, and immediate reporting of public health risks.

- **Food Safety Compliance Officer (FSCO) / Quality Assurance (QA):** The designated personnel responsible for executing internal traceability audits, reviewing safety logs, and coordinating external testing or regulatory interventions.
- **Traceability ("One Step Back, One Step Forward"):** The rigorous tracking protocol ensures the exact identification of ingredient suppliers ("one step back") and the final recipients or dispatch routes of products ("one step forward").
- **Crisis Management Team (CMT):** The activated internal response hierarchy consisted of the President, Vice President, FSCO/QA, Area Managers, and SCM Managers tasked with managing emergencies, closures, and regulatory notifications.
- **Corrective Action and Preventive Actions(CAPA):** Strategic, systemic interventions designed to eliminate the root causes of identified food safety failures to prevent their recurrence.
- **Non-Conformance Report (NCR):** A formal document recording a procedural failure, its immediate correction, root-cause analysis, and subsequent disciplinary or training actions, serving as legal proof of corporate due diligence.

5. Crisis Management Team

5.1. Learning & Development (L&D) Manager

The Learning and Development (L&D) Manager is the initial point of contact for customer complaints, receiving feedback through established channels, providing acknowledgement promptly and documenting the nature and severity of the issue. To establish the foundation for the investigation, they must accurately collect all relevant data, such as customer contact information, product or service details, and event timeframe into the company's tracking system. Once documented, the L&D Manager ensures a seamless transition by immediately escalating the issue to the Area Manager, allowing the investigation to begin without delay.

5.2. Area Manager (AM)

The Area Manager is responsible for conducting a thorough investigation to determine the cause, scope, and impact of the issue by gathering evidence, interviewing employees, and assessing the validity of the claim. Once the investigation is complete, the Area Manager takes ownership of executing immediate resolution and applying company protocols to effectively resolve the customer's issue and prevent further escalation. To conclude the process, the Area Manager records all findings and outcomes. This documentation is then handed over to the Crisis Management Facilitator (FSCO/QA), who issues the Non-Conformance Report (NCR) and establishes Corrective and Preventive Actions (CAPA).

5.3. Operations Manager (OM)

The Operations Manager oversees the broader operational impact during a food safety emergency, ensuring that all immediate containment procedures are strictly enforced across affected branches. While the Area Manager conducts the initial investigation and handles immediate resolution, the Operations Manager oversees large-scale logistics, such as executing temporary halts in affected areas, adjusting service workflows, and reallocating personnel to unaffected areas. Furthermore, they serve as the crucial link between ground-level operations and the executive team, ensuring that the Corrective and Preventive Actions (CAPA) developed by the Food Safety Compliance Officer (FSCO/QA) are

successfully implemented on the restaurant floor prior to the resumption of normal operations.

5.4. Supply Chain Management (SCM) Manager / Supervisor

The SCM team is notified simultaneously with the FSCO/QA to manage immediate physical risks. Their focus is purely logistical: tracing the exact origin of the problematic product, ingredient, or equipment throughout the distribution network. They systematically quarantine all related inventory across warehouses and in transit and manage the communication with external vendors regarding risks. Their focus is purely logistical: tracing the exact origin of the problematic product, ingredient, or equipment throughout the distribution network. They systematically quarantine all related inventory across warehouses and in transit and manage the communication with external vendors regarding

5.5. Food Safety Compliance Officer or Quality Assurance (FSCO / QA)

The FSCO or QA receives the incident details and preliminary investigation and resolution from the Area Manager. With these insights, they take charge of the formal investigation, reviewing the SCM tracing data and Area Manager assessment. They then issue the formal Non-Conformance Report (NCR) and develop the robust, systemic Corrective and Preventive Actions (CAPA) necessary to permanently eliminate the root causes.

5.6. Vice President

The Vice President works alongside the President to guide high-level strategic decisions and oversee resource allocation. They hold the authority to approve resources, allocate emergency funding, or authorize necessary operational pauses required to implement the CAPA effectively. They continuously brief the President on the trajectory and potential financial/regulatory risks.

5.7. President or Owner

The President or Owner retains ultimate accountability for the organization's overall crisis response and regulatory compliance. They serve as the final executive authority, tasked with authorizing major public statements, approving high-level legal strategies, and making the final decisions regarding wide-scale recalls or major organizational policy shifts

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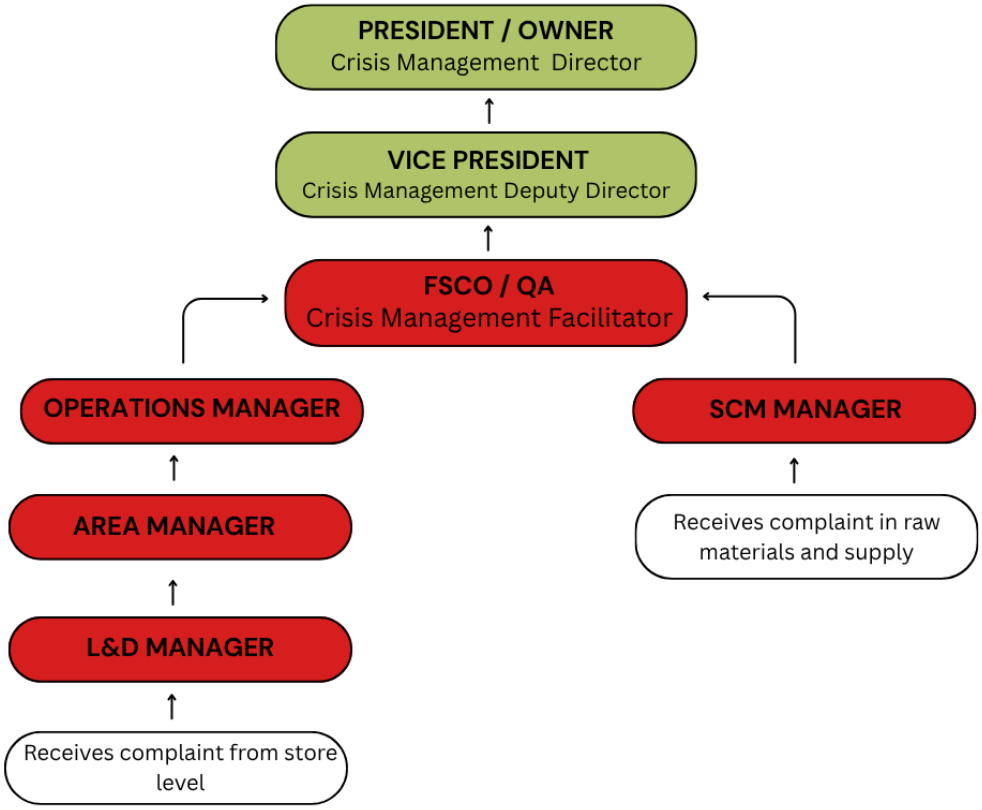


Figure 1. Crisis Management Team Structure.

6. Crisis Management

Phase 1: Preparedness and Prevention (Pre Crisis)

a. **Risk Assessment and HACCP:** The company shall maintain a Hazard Analysis and Critical Control Point (HACCP) framework to systematically identify, monitor, and mitigate biological, chemical, and physical hazards across all operational workflows.

b. **Traceability Protocols:** The company must enforce rigorous "one step back, one step forward" traceability. This ensures the precise identification of all ingredient suppliers and, where applicable to dispatch or catering, the final recipients of the products.

c. **Supplier Accreditation:** Procurement is strictly limited to vendors demonstrating full compliance with Department of Agriculture (DA) and Food and Drug Administration (FDA) safety standards. Comprehensive receiving manifests and QA Logs must be maintained continuously.

Phase 2: Crisis Response Protocol

a. **Immediate Containment—**In alignment with RA 10611, immediate corrective action is required upon reasonable suspicion of compromised food safety, preceding conclusive scientific validation.

   i. **Operational Suspension:** Immediately withdraw any suspected dishes or core ingredients from circulation. If overall facility integrity is compromised, operational activities must be temporarily halted.

ii. **Evidence Isolation:** Secure all suspected food items, raw materials, and associated batches. These items must be clearly designated “DO NOT USE” and retained securely for potential laboratory analysis in third-party testing laboratories.

iii. **Records Securitization:** Promptly aggregate all relevant documentation, including receiving manifests, temperature logs, and personnel health records corresponding to the incident timeframe.

b. **Notification and Compliance**

i. **Internal Escalation:** Formally activate the Crisis Management Team

ii. **Regulatory Notification:** In compliance with statutory mandates, management must immediately report the incident to the LGU/Municipal Health Office and the FDA/DOH if there is a reasonable belief that the store’s food poses a public health risk.

iii. **Emergency Medical Response:** Facilitate immediate medical transport for any guest/customer exhibiting severe symptoms while on the premises.

c. **Strategic Communications**

i. **Validation and Acknowledgement:** Receive customer reports with professional empathy. Ensure guests/customers understand the gravity which the company treats the matter, affirming that an official investigation has been launched.

ii. **Liability and Management:** Refrain from premature admissions of liability prior to conclusive laboratory findings. Communications must emphasize the ongoing investigative process rather than assigning internal fault.

iii. **Centralized Messaging:** All external communications and media inquiries must be exclusively routed through communications lead or crisis management director to ensure cohesive, legally sound, and accurate public messaging.

Phase 3: Operational Recovery and Post-Crisis Evaluation

a. **Corrective and Preventive Actions (CAPA):** Implement strategic interventions addressing the root cause identified by the FSCO and DOH. This may necessitate vendor termination, comprehensive staff retraining on sanitation protocols, or the upgrading of operational equipment

b. **Regulatory Clearance Authorization:** Full operational resumption or the reinstatement of suspended menu items is strictly prohibited until formal, written clearance is granted by the local sanitary inspector or relevant regulatory authority.

c. **Post-Incident Audit:** The Crisis Management Team (CMT) shall convene to conduct a comprehensive review of the crisis response. The Crisis Management Program must be updated and integrate systematic improvements based on these findings.

d. **Stakeholder Transparency:** Execute a structured communication strategy to inform the guests/customers of the corrective measures implemented, highlighting newly acquired safety certifications or reinforced protocols to restore brand trust.

7. Corrective Action for Non-Compliance

To establish a standardized response for instances where employees fail to adhere to established Food Safety and Crisis Management procedures, ensuring immediate correction, root-cause resolution, and appropriate disciplinary action.

7.1. **Immediate Intervention and Correction:** When a procedural failure is identified (e.g., failing to isolate suspected contaminated food, dismissing a customer’s illness complaint, or falsifying temperature logs), the immediate priority is to secure the operation.

a. **Halt the Unsafe Act:** The Area Manager or Food Safety Compliance Officer (FSCO) just immediately intervenes to halt the non-compliant action.
b. **Execute the Proper Procedure:** Management must instantly take over the situation to ensure the correct standard operating procedures (SOP) is executed without further delay

7.2. **Root Cause Analysis:** Before issuing disciplinary action, management must determine why the procedure was not followed to differentiate between a system failure and employee negligence.

a. **Knowledge Deficit:** Did the employee fail to understand the SOP? **(Requires training)**
b. **System/Resource Failure:** Was the employee unable to execute the SOP due to broken equipment or lack of materials? **(Requires operational fixing)**
c. **Willful Negligence/Insubordination:** Did the employee know the procedure but actively choose to ignore it? **(Requires immediate disciplinary action)**

7.3. **Disciplinary Matrix:** Since food safety directly impacts public health and brand survival, disciplinary actions for SOP violations are categorized by severity. All actions must be documented in the employee's HR file.

Severity	Definition and Examples	Disciplinary Action
Minor Infraction	Unintentional errors with no immediate risk to health *Example:* Failing to fill-out one column on a temperature log; Server behavior when interacting with guest/customer	**1st Offense:** Verbal Warning (Written Reminder) **2nd Offense:** Incident Report (Written Reprimand) and Retraining in food safety
Major Infraction	Negligence that creates a potential health risk or violates RA 10611 traceability mandates *Example:* Failing to HOLD suspected item/dish' Mixing new batches with suspected contaminated batches; Failing to escalate an illness complaint to management	**1st Offense:** Incident Report (Written Reprimand) and Retraining in food safety **2nd Offense:** 3 Days Suspension
Critical Infraction	Willful endangerment, gross negligence, or intentional cover-ups *Example:* Serving food known to be contaminated, falsifying regulatory HACCP/temperature logs; Hiding a health inspector's notice	**1st Offense:** 30 days preventive suspension pending investigation, leading to termination.

Note: *All disciplinary actions, including preventive suspension and termination arising from violations such as those under RA No. 10611 or Food Safety Act or 2013 and company policies, shall strictly undergo proper due process.*

- **Mandatory Retraining and Re-evaluation**
  a. **Targeted Retraining:** The employee must undergo specific retraining on the failed SOP led by the FSCO/QA before being allowed to return to their normal duties
  b. **Supervised Probation:** The employee's compliance with the specific SOP must be closely monitored and signed off by the Restaurant Manager for the next 14 shifts.
- **Documentation (Non- Conformance Report):** Every procedural failure and subsequent corrective action must be documented using a Non-Conformance Report (NCR). This document serves as legal proof of the establishment's due diligence in managing its staff and enforcing food safety standards. The NCR must include:
  a. Description of the procedural failure
  b. The immediate corrective action taken
  c. The root cause identified
  d. The disciplinary action and retraining plan
  e. Signatures of the employee, FSCO/QA, and Crisis Director

8. Verification

To maintain SOP compliance and legality, the FSCO/QA and Supply Chain Manager must conduct routine log audits and mock traceability tests. Following any crisis, the Crisis Management Team (CMT) must review the response timeline to update safety protocols and CAPA implementation. Additionally, non-compliant employees must undergo retraining and a 14-shift supervised probation, while resuming operations or menu items strictly requires securing and archiving written regulatory clearance.

9. Change History

Revision No.:	Revision Date:	Author & Position:	Purpose of Revision
0	March 25, 2026	Marielle Louise Macabale**, QA Specialist**	Originator
1	June 3, 2026	Celine Joy Sanchez**, QA Specialist**	• Added Definition of Terms and Verification
2	June 26, 2026	Celine Joy Sanchez**, QA Specialist**	• Revised Crisis Management Team • Added L&D Manager and Operations Manager • Added responsibilities

	Name	Position	Signature with Date
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